# SDG 9: INDUSTRY, INNOVATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE PROGRESS REPORT

Sustainable Development Goal 9 (SDG 9): Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure is one of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, focusing on building resilient infrastructure, promoting inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and fostering innovation. It recognizes that reliable infrastructure, technological advancement, scientific research, and innovation are essential to sustainable economic growth and social development. SDG 9 also emphasizes the importance of expanding access to information and communication technologies, strengthening research and development capabilities, improving technological resources, and encouraging collaboration among educational institutions, government agencies, industries, and other sectors. Through these efforts, institutions can help develop solutions to societal challenges, improve access to knowledge, and create opportunities for innovation and long-term development.

Higher education institutions play an important role in advancing SDG 9 by providing environments where research, creativity, technology, and knowledge exchange can flourish. Colleges and universities contribute through research initiatives, technical and professional development, digital infrastructure, academic partnerships, and the dissemination of scholarly findings. Their engagement with government agencies, research organizations, and industry partners can also help strengthen research funding opportunities, improve institutional capabilities, and connect academic knowledge with practical applications. Furthermore, access to digital technologies and reliable internet connectivity supports teaching, learning, research collaboration, and the exchange of information, allowing educational institutions to participate more actively in local, national, and international innovation networks.

In this context, the City College of Cagayan de Oro (CCCDO) contributes to SDG 9 through initiatives that support digital connectivity, research development, technical capabilities, scholarly dissemination, and institutional collaboration. This report examines the College's contributions by comparing the available 2024 institutional report with the January–October 2025 SDG 9 narrative. It highlights the development of CCCDO's initiatives, particularly its efforts to improve access to digital infrastructure, strengthen research capacity, participate in research and innovation networks, and provide platforms for academic exchange. Among the notable initiatives in 2025 are the launch of the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT) Region X Free Wi-Fi for All project at CCCDO, participation in the National RITE 2 project, engagement with the Department of Science and Technology–Philippine Council for Industry, Energy, and Emerging Technology Research and Development (DOST-PCIEERD) regarding research funding opportunities, and the organization of research conferences that encourage scholarly presentation and collaboration.

The comparison also considers relevant cross-cutting contributions identified in the available 2024 report, which formally focuses on Sustainable Development Goal 8 (SDG 8): Decent Work and Economic Growth. These contributions are included only where they relate to SDG 9, particularly in industry collaboration, applied technical capabilities, research, and resource mobilization. This distinction ensures that the analysis accurately represents the scope of the available institutional evidence without treating SDG 8 figures as official SDG 9 activity totals.

Overall, the report presents CCCDO's continuing efforts to create an academic environment that supports technological advancement, research productivity, knowledge sharing, and innovation through institutional initiatives and collaboration with external partners.

## Key Findings

- The 2024 institutional baseline records technical training, industry partnerships, one research publication, and resource mobilization—capabilities that provide a related context for SDG 9, although the source report classifies them primarily under SDG 8.
- The 2025 SDG 9 narrative covers research creation and recognition, innovation proposal development, research management, technology exchange, institutional partnerships, and digital infrastructure.
- The Free Wi-Fi for All project progressed from an initial inspection in February 2025 to a reported launch in March 2025, demonstrating movement from project preparation to an implemented digital-access initiative.
- The 2025 research festival reported 96 paper presenters and 33 walk-in participants, while the narrative also records four CCCDO personnel appearing in a scientist-ranking list and three research wins at an international conference and national convention.
- Taken together, the records show a broader documented network around research, innovation and connectivity in 2025. They do not support a single numeric growth rate for SDG 9 because the 2024 and 2025 source documents use different classifications and coverage.

## Institutional Context and Comparative Basis

SDG 9 promotes resilient infrastructure, inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and innovation. In higher education, these priorities can be expressed through accessible digital systems, research and development, technology transfer, innovation-focused proposals, academic-industry collaboration, research training, and platforms that allow knowledge to be tested, shared, and applied. These institutional activities create enabling conditions for technological development and knowledge production, even when the final economic or social effects occur beyond the reporting period.

The comparison combines two source types. The 2024 PDF is titled "Progress Report on SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth." It contains documented data on technical training, industry links, resource support, and one research publication. These items are used only where they provide relevant cross-cutting context for research, industry connection, and capability development. The 2025 narrative is explicitly about SDG 9 and covers activities from January to October 2025. Because the source structures differ, this report compares the nature and development of documented institutional contributions rather than treating activity counts as directly equivalent annual totals.

## 2024 Baseline: Industry Linkages, Technical Capability and Applied Research

### Industry-connected capability and technical resources

The 2024 report records five industry partnerships within its programmatic activity chart and documents collaborations with TESDA Region X, Department of Tourism Region X, PESO-CDO, Pilipinas Shell Foundation Inc. (PSFI), Hotel 801, and FICCO. Although these partnerships are primarily discussed through the lens of employment and training, they also represent links between institutional capability and operational practice. Collaboration with

industry and government can expose students and faculty to equipment, technical standards, real-world processes, and applied problems that inform innovation.

The report describes 855 Technical Skills and Technology Institute (TSTI) graduates, more than 400 trainees certified through technical-vocational programs, and 122 students participating in industry-linked training and practicum experiences. It also records one major donation of training consumables and equipment from PSFI. These numbers do not constitute SDG 9-specific outputs; rather, they show a 2024 institutional environment in which technical skills, industry relationships, hands-on facilities, and practical learning formed a base for further technology-oriented development.

### Research and knowledge output

The 2024 report lists one research publication, titled “Influence of Self-Efficacy, Teachers’ Stress, and Demographics on Work Commitment and Intention to Stay.” Its main subject is workforce well-being, which is more directly aligned with SDG 8, but the presence of a documented research output is relevant to the College’s broader research culture. The report also describes collaboration with industry mentors and competency-based technical training. Together, those elements indicate that applied learning, practical resources, and research were present in the institutional context before the more explicitly SDG 9-oriented digital and research-network activities reported in 2025.

### The 2024 baseline in perspective

The selected 2024 figures show a programmatic profile centered on technical training and industry partnership, with smaller reported counts for research publication and resource mobilization. This is a useful contextual baseline for understanding institutional capability. It should not be interpreted as a comprehensive count of SDG 9 activities, since the underlying document reports these figures under SDG 8 and focuses primarily on employability and workforce development.

## 2025 Progress: Digital Infrastructure, Innovation and Research Networks

### Digital infrastructure: Free Wi-Fi for All

CCCDO’s collaboration with DICT Region X is one of the clearest infrastructure milestones in the 2025 narrative. DICT Region X conducted an initial inspection for the Free Wi-Fi project on February 7, 2025, and the College reported the launch of Free Wi-Fi for All on March 18, 2025 [23, 27]. This sequence shows progress from site assessment and preparation to a publicly reported service launch.

Campus connectivity is relevant to SDG 9 because digital infrastructure affects how students and faculty access information, scholarly content, online learning materials, research tools, and academic communication. Compared with the 2024 baseline, where the supplied source emphasized technical capability and industry links, the Wi-Fi project makes digital infrastructure a more explicit and visible part of the institutional contribution. The project’s significance lies in the service and opportunity it enables: a campus connection can support a wider range of learning and research tasks, particularly where students depend on shared access to digital resources.

### Research and innovation as an organized institutional activity

The 2025 narrative describes a series of activities that connect research ideas with institutional planning and external support. In January, CCCDO held a strategic alignment meeting on

potential research and innovation for Cagayan de Oro [29]. In February, the College explored research funding opportunities with DOST-PCIEERD [26]. In March, it joined a full-blown proposal-development writeshop [20], and in July, participated in a DEPDev-X writeshop focused on strengthening innovation proposals [8]. These activities reflect a process-oriented approach to innovation: identifying priorities, structuring research ideas, and connecting proposals with potential support or partners.

The report also records the College's approval as a research partner in the national RITE 2 project in May [13] and approval of a mentorship research initiative by the Teacher Education Council [16]. Such developments connect individual researchers with institutional partnerships and structured research arrangements. They matter because innovation depends not only on the presence of ideas, but on the capacity to formulate projects, organize collaboration, and engage with relevant research and development programs.

### Research management and faculty capacity

In October 2025, CCCDO leaders completed an executive course at De La Salle University focused on research management and alignment with the Sustainable Development Goals [4]. In August, CCCDO officials served as resource persons in a nationwide Alternative Learning System research workshop, including technical contribution to the validation of data-gathering instruments [6]. Faculty members also took part in BRIGHT 2025 and Project MENTOR research evaluation activities in October [3].

These activities extend the institutional research environment beyond the production of papers. Research management, methods support, mentorship, and evaluation develop the skills required to organize projects, improve the quality of research processes, and participate in wider scholarly systems. Their relevance to SDG 9 lies in the infrastructure of knowledge production: staff capability, institutional coordination, and research practices are essential conditions for continued innovation.

### Research recognition, visibility and publication

The College's 2025 narrative reports that four personnel secured places in the World Scientist and University Rankings 2025 in February [28], followed by the College's entry into the AD Scientific Index World Scientist and University Rankings 2025 in July [10]. The College also reported success at the 2025 International Research Conference in March [19], recognition at the Second TVET Research Conference in May [15], a presentation of CCCDO research at an international conference on Asian and Philippine Studies in June [11], and three research wins at the Fifth International Conference and 2025 NOTED National Convention in September [5].

The narrative further records a study on the Alternative Learning System co-published by the CCCDO vice president and a Xavier University dean in a European academic journal [24], alongside participation in the launch of the Mindanao Journal of Alternative Education Studies in March [22]. These are primarily academic and educational research achievements, but they contribute to SDG 9's innovation dimension by expanding channels for creating, evaluating, and disseminating knowledge. Ranking placements and awards signal visibility and recognition; they are not, by themselves, proof that a technology or research finding has been adopted in the wider economy.

### Research conferences and multidisciplinary knowledge exchange

A significant event in the 2025 record was the First International Research Conference and Second Higalaay Multidisciplinary Research Festival, hosted by CCCDO in August [7]. The

source reports 96 paper presenters and 33 walk-in participants, alongside international plenary speakers and collaboration involving a consortium of local colleges in Misamis Oriental. This makes the event a measurable platform for the exchange of ideas and academic work across disciplines.

The College also participated in the USTP Research Summit as panelists in May [14], the UNLIRICE Talk Series [17], the 74th PhilAAST Annual Convention and Mindanao Forum on Blue Economy and Food Security in July [9], and a global technology exchange at ITS CommTech Insight 2025 in February [25]. In October, James S. Clarke was featured as a plenary speaker in an institutional event [1]. These activities broadened the spaces where CCCDO personnel could exchange expertise, present research, discuss technology, and connect with other institutions.

### Technology exchange and innovation-related engagement

The 2025 report records CCCDO faculty participation as judges for the Eighth RTX Invention Convention U.S. Nationals in May [12] and engagement in several technology, research, and innovation forums. Such activities bring faculty members into settings where new ideas and projects are presented and assessed. The motorcycle-mounted hybrid wind- and solar-powered mobile charger project, mentioned in the narrative's account of the International Research Conference, is a concrete example of applied technological exploration [19]. It links academic inquiry with a practical power-related use case and illustrates how innovation can involve experimentation with alternative energy sources and mobile charging needs.

The value of these engagements is not limited to a single project or conference. Participation in technology exchange and invention evaluation exposes researchers to new approaches and potential applications, while proposal writeshops and research partnerships provide channels through which ideas can be refined and developed into organized projects.

### Institutional and inter-agency collaboration

Collaboration remained a recurring feature of CCCDO's 2025 SDG 9-related activity. The College worked with DICT Region X on campus connectivity, engaged DOST-PCIEERD on research funding opportunities, participated in innovation proposal development with DEPDev-X, and joined the national RITE 2 project. Its research conferences and forums also involved academic institutions and professional networks. These relationships link local institutional activity to national research agendas, digital infrastructure programs, and wider scholarly communities.

Compared with the 2024 source's emphasis on industry and technical-training partners, the 2025 narrative presents a more research-centered and digital-infrastructure-focused partnership network. This does not mean that industry collaboration ceased; rather, the documented emphasis broadened to include digital access, research development, innovation funding pathways, research evaluation, and academic knowledge exchange.

### How the Institutional Contribution Evolved and Why It Matters

The comparison suggests three interrelated developments. First, the 2024 context was strongest in practical technical capability and industry collaboration, including training infrastructure, partner relationships, and a documented research output. Second, the 2025 account made digital access concrete through the launch of Free Wi-Fi for All. Third, research and innovation became more visible as an organized institutional network involving

proposal-development workshops, research partnerships, mentorship, management training, conference hosting, research recognition, and technology exchange.

These shifts matter because infrastructure and innovation reinforce one another. Digital access supports the use and circulation of knowledge; research capacity makes it possible to investigate needs and develop solutions; proposal development and partnerships can connect ideas with funding and expertise; and scholarly events allow findings to be tested and communicated. For a higher education institution, SDG 9 therefore extends beyond physical structures. It includes the digital and organizational systems that help knowledge, research, and technology move between campus, government, academic partners, and communities.

At the same time, the evidence types must remain distinct. The 2024 program counts belong to the supplied SDG 8 report and should be interpreted as cross-cutting institutional context. The 2025 figures of 96 paper presenters, 33 walk-in participants, four personnel listed in research rankings, and three research wins are selected reported milestones, not a unified measure of impact. Their value is in illustrating the breadth of research activity and visibility rather than creating a single composite score.

## Figures and Comparative Analysis

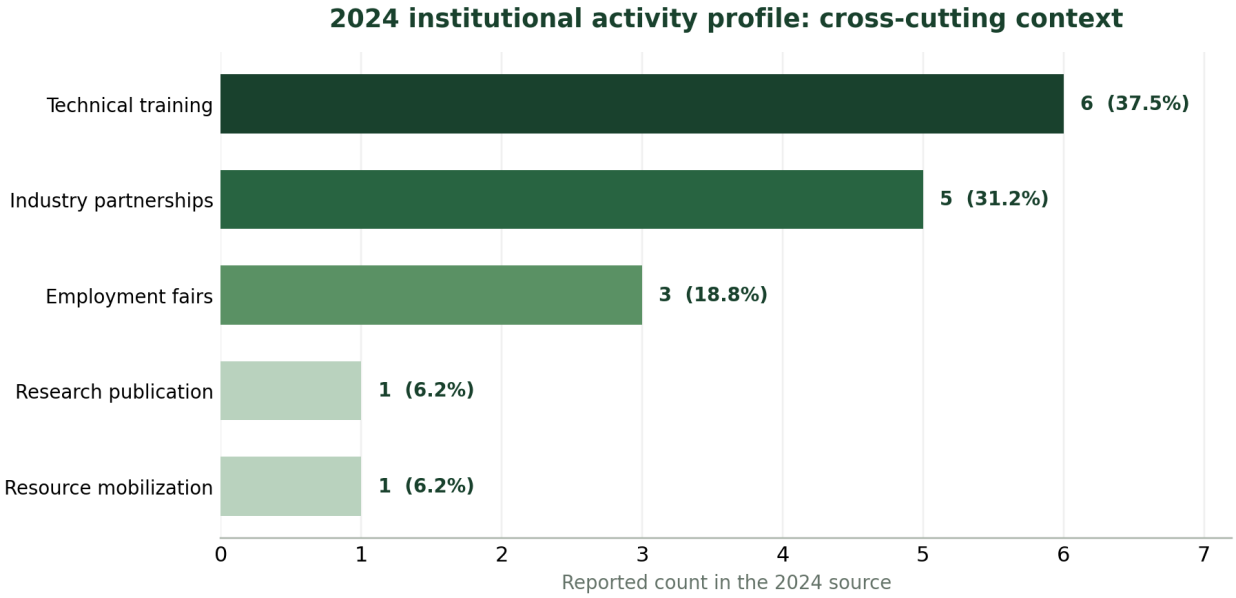



*Figure 1. Reported 2024 activity counts from the supplied SDG 8 report, used only as cross-cutting context for technical capability, industry relationships, research and institutional resources.*

Interpretation: Technical training accounts for six of the 16 programmatic examples counted in the source chart (37.5%), followed by industry partnerships at five (31.2%) and employment fairs at three (18.8%). Research publication and resource mobilization each account for one example (6.2% each). The pattern suggests that the 2024 institutional context was weighted toward applied technical capability and industry engagement. For SDG 9, these areas are relevant as foundational supports for technological competence and collaboration, but the chart is not an official SDG 9 activity distribution.

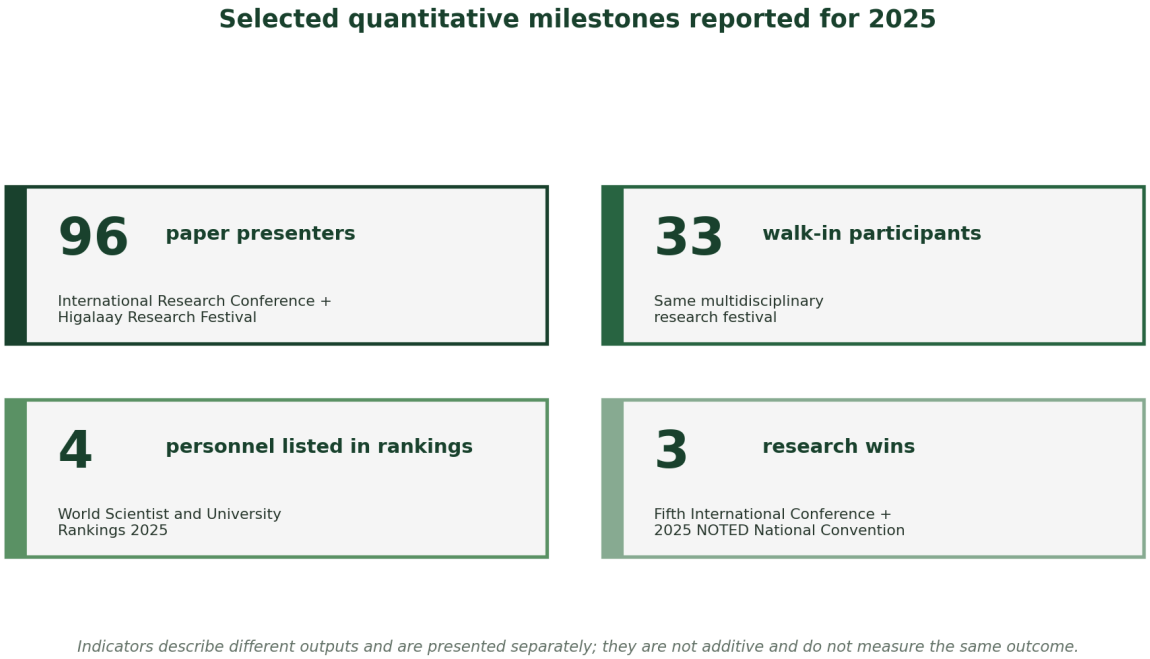



*Figure 2. Selected quantitative milestones explicitly stated in the January–October 2025 SDG 9 narrative. Categories are shown separately because their units differ.*

Interpretation: The research festival's 96 paper presenters and 33 walk-in participants illustrate the scale of one documented knowledge-sharing event. Four personnel were reported as securing places in a scientist-ranking list, and three research wins were reported at the Fifth International Conference and 2025 NOTED National Convention. These figures indicate participation, recognition, and dissemination across different channels. They should not be added together or treated as a single performance score, because each describes a different kind of activity.




*Figure 3. Selected 2025 milestones organized chronologically from January through October.*

Interpretation: The timeline shows that the 2025 SDG 9 narrative was not centered on a single event. It began with strategic alignment and research-funding engagement, moved through the February inspection and March launch of campus Wi-Fi, continued with research proposals and partnerships in the middle of the year, and included a research festival, research recognition, and institutional research-management activities later in the reporting period. This sequence illustrates activity across planning, implementation, knowledge exchange, and institutional capacity-building.

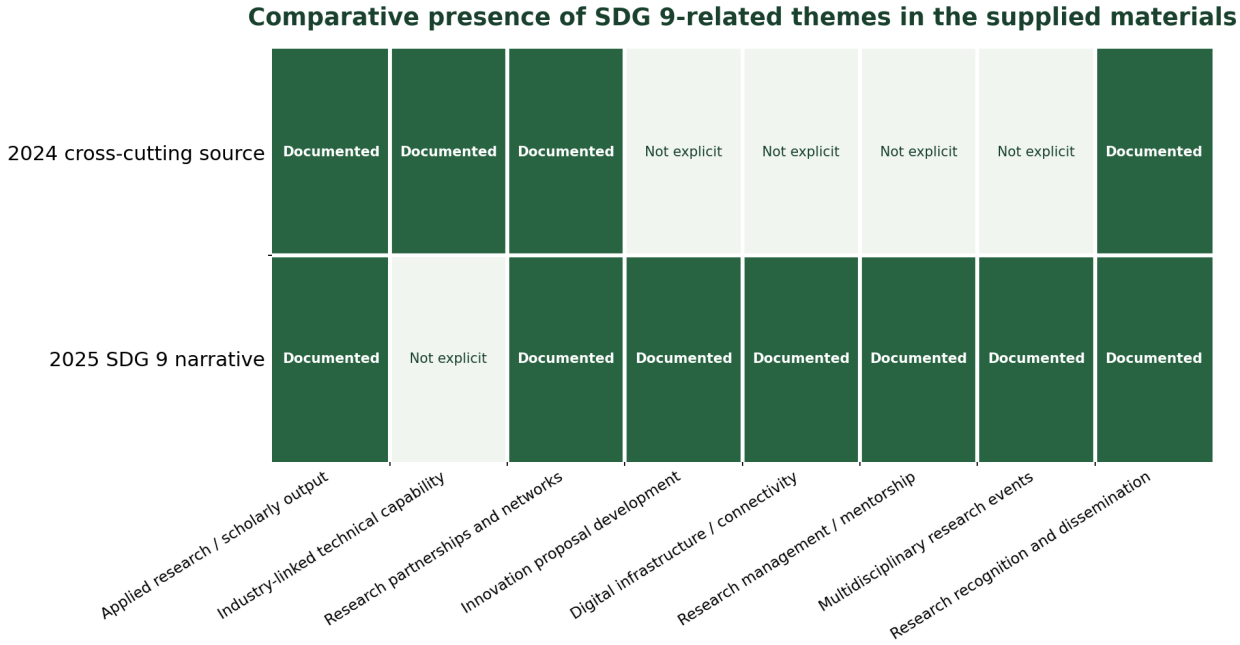



*Figure 4. Presence of selected SDG 9-related themes in the supplied source materials. "Not explicit" refers only to the coverage of the source reviewed.*

Interpretation: The 2024 baseline documents adjacent strengths in research output, industry-linked capability, research-related partnerships, and dissemination. The 2025 narrative makes innovation proposal development, digital infrastructure, research management and mentorship, multidisciplinary research events, and scholarly recognition explicit. This comparison supports the conclusion that the reported institutional portfolio broadened in visibility and scope during 2025, while avoiding a claim that the number of all SDG 9 activities increased by a precisely measurable percentage.

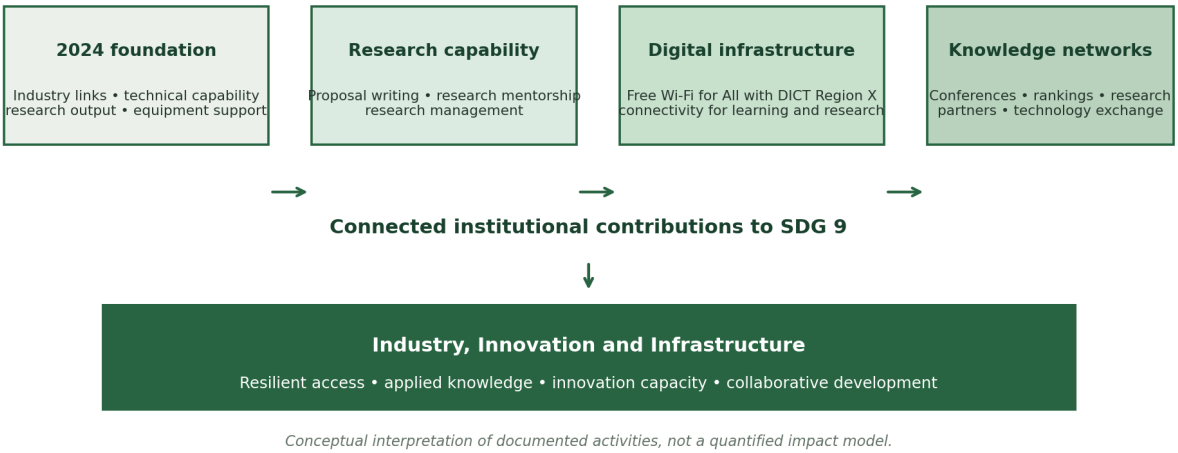



*Figure 5. Conceptual pathway showing how the 2024 capability base and 2025 institutional initiatives connect to intended SDG 9 contributions.*

Interpretation: The pathway links technical capability and industry relationships in the 2024 context to the more explicit research systems and digital infrastructure documented in 2025. Proposal development and research management help organize and sustain research activity; campus connectivity supports access to digital information; partnerships and research networks enable expertise and ideas to circulate. Together these elements illustrate how a higher education institution can contribute to industry, innovation and infrastructure through both technology services and the institutional capacity that supports knowledge production.

## Comparative Summary of Institutional Development

| Dimension | 2024 cross-cutting baseline | 2025 SDG 9 documentation | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Applied research and knowledge output | One research publication is recorded in the supplied SDG 8 report; industry-linked technical learning is also described. | Research conference success, scholarly presentations, research publication, national RITE 2 partnership, research festival and research recognition are documented. | Research became more visible through multiple channels of creation, presentation, recognition and collaboration. |
| Industry and institutional collaboration | Five industry partnerships are counted in the source activity chart; partners include TESDA, DOT-X, PESO-CDO, PSFI, Hotel 801 and FICCO. | DICT Region X, DOST-PCIEERD, DEPDev-X, RITE 2, academic institutions, and professional research networks appear in the narrative. | The documented partner network broadened in emphasis from technical/industry relationships toward research development and digital infrastructure. |

| Dimension | 2024 cross-cutting baseline | 2025 SDG 9 documentation | Interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Innovation development | Training resources and applied technical capability provide a related foundation; innovation proposal processes are not prominent in the supplied 2024 report. | Strategic alignment, two proposal-development writeshops, innovation consultation and invention-event judging are described. | The 2025 account places clearer emphasis on turning ideas into structured proposals and connecting them to research and innovation opportunities. |
| Digital infrastructure | The supplied 2024 SDG 8 report does not explicitly describe a comparable digital-connectivity project. | DICT inspection in February followed by Free Wi-Fi for All launch in March 2025. | A concrete digital infrastructure service became a prominent component of the 2025 institutional contribution. |
| Research capacity and leadership | The 2024 source lists training and institutional resources, but does not detail comparable research-management and mentorship activities. | Executive course on research management, ALS research workshop resource persons, research mentorship approval, research evaluation and rankings are documented. | The 2025 narrative makes organizational capacity and participation in research networks more explicit. |
| Knowledge exchange and research event scale | The source notes skills expos and employer summits, but not a comparable research-festival participation count. | Research festival reports 96 paper presenters and 33 walk-in participants; other forums and conferences are also listed. | The 2025 record illustrates wider scholarly exchange and the College's role in convening a research community. |

## Contribution to SDG 9 Priorities

| SDG 9 priority | Relevant documented CCCDO activity | How the contribution matters |
|---|---|---|
| Resilient and accessible infrastructure | Free Wi-Fi for All with DICT Region X; initial site inspection and subsequent launch. | Digital connectivity supports access to electronic learning materials, research resources, academic communication and technology-enabled education. |
| Research and technological capability | Applied research project involving a motorcycle-mounted hybrid | Applied inquiry connects academic knowledge with practical problems and |

| SDG 9 priority | Relevant documented CCCDO activity | How the contribution matters |
|---|---|---|
| | wind- and solar-powered mobile charger; research presentations, publication and invention-related engagement. | encourages development and evaluation of technical solutions. |
| Innovation development | Strategic alignment meeting, innovation consultations, proposal-development writeshops with institutional and regional partners. | Structured proposals help turn ideas into defined research projects and communicate their methods, potential uses and resource requirements. |
| Research and development partnerships | National RITE 2 project, DOST-PCIEERD engagement, DEPDev-X collaboration, academic and professional research networks. | Partnerships connect research teams with expertise, funding pathways, feedback and wider institutional priorities. |
| Knowledge creation and dissemination | First International Research Conference and Second Higalaay Multidisciplinary Research Festival; conferences, publications and research recognition. | Knowledge exchange allows research findings and methods to circulate among researchers, educators and partner institutions. |
| Institutional research capacity | Research-management course, faculty mentorship approval, participation in research evaluation and ALS research workshop. | Research capability relies on people, processes and leadership as well as individual research outputs. |

## Conclusion

The 2024–2025 comparison portrays CCCDO's documented institutional development as moving from a foundation of technical capability, industry relationships, applied learning resources, and an existing research output toward a more explicitly articulated research, innovation, and digital-infrastructure portfolio in 2025. The 2024 PDF provides relevant cross-cutting context but is classified under SDG 8; the 2025 narrative directly frames the College's activities under SDG 9 and details a wider set of research and innovation milestones.

The launch of Free Wi-Fi for All represents a visible digital-infrastructure development. Alongside it, the College's research partnerships, proposal-development writeshops, research management activities, festival hosting, research recognition, publications, and technology exchange show how innovation depends on both infrastructure and institutional capacity. The reported 96 paper presenters and 33 walk-in participants at the research festival, four personnel listed in a scientist-ranking list, and three research wins illustrate the breadth of research participation and visibility documented during 2025.

Overall, the evidence supports a conclusion that CCCDO's reported SDG 9 portfolio broadened in 2025 in its explicit focus on digital connectivity, organized research development,

and multidisciplinary knowledge exchange. These contributions matter because resilient infrastructure, research capacity, innovation processes, and partnerships reinforce one another: digital access enables knowledge use, research capability produces ideas and evidence, and collaborative platforms allow those ideas to be shared and developed in response to educational and community needs.

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